

---

## Introduction

In addition to the fact that the final product may be unpredictable, many outcomes are **invisible and intangible**. This is where the **learning effect** comes into play. A desired outcome is that all participants learn throughout the collaboration. Learning can occur on a **cognitive level**, in **skills**, or in the **development of values**. For some participants, such as students, learning is an obvious and important goal. However, other participants should also benefit from the transdisciplinary collaboration in terms of learning.

Read more  
on the **theory page**, and view examples under the **practice tab**.

## Theory

### Professional Development

As previously quoted, in this educational context, it's the journey—not the destination—that matters most. The intangible development of **transversal competencies** and the **inner growth** each participant undergoes carries more weight than the final result achieved by the team. All participants work on their **personal and professional development**. By addressing a complex problem from multiple perspectives—both interdisciplinary and cross-sectoral—people learn about their own expertise through others' reflections, and about others' experience and expertise. As explained in "*What to Learn*," much inner development takes place in **being, thinking, relating, collaborating, and acting**.

## Intrinsic Value

---

Another transformation may occur within the **values** of the participants. By introducing other perspectives, values can shift. For example, when students from Business Innovation collaborated with partners at *De Kleine Aarde*, an ecological center affiliated with Avans University of Applied Sciences, they reported a change in their views on meat consumption. They became aware of the holistic consequences of meat production. This **personal value transformation** was, in this case, a significant possible outcome.

## Education for the Future

The invisible outcomes of a transdisciplinary project can go beyond the individual level. In democratic countries like the Netherlands, citizens must have a strong sense of value to participate in democracy. Transdisciplinary education—which crosses boundaries and combines multiple perspectives—can play an active role in this political field (Hoggan & Hoggan-Kloubert, 2023).

### Reference:

Hoggan, C., & Hoggan-Kloubert, T. (2023). *The ethics of radical and transformative education*. *Adult Education Quarterly*, 73(4), 363–381.

## Practice

*This page is still under development. Examples will follow soon.*

*Sign up for the TRAIL newsletter to stay informed about content updates.*

